

E2 Knowledge Sharing Diagnostic

Formerly: Centralised Knowledge Repository. Absorbs E7 (Streamlining Knowledge Management). Restructured from a project plan into a diagnostic exercise.

Pillar	Enablement	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	40-50 minutes	Group Size	4-12
Mode	Team facilitation	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	None	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Inefficient knowledge sharing, information silos, knowledge trapped in individuals' heads, onboarding difficulties, repeated mistakes from lost institutional knowledge

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Knowledge hoarding (intentional or accidental) creates cognitive load for the entire team. When critical information lives in one person's head, every other team member must expend brain resources navigating around that bottleneck: waiting for responses, working with incomplete information, or duplicating effort because they don't know what already exists. This is metabolically expensive for the brain and produces chronic, low-level frustration that erodes enablement scores.

Making knowledge accessible reduces individual cognitive load and increases the team's collective intelligence. When information is findable, the brain can focus on using it rather than hunting for it. The dopamine reward system also responds to self-sufficiency: being able to find what you need without depending on someone else's availability feels competent and empowering.

The Exercise

Phase 1: The Knowledge Trap Map (15 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Where is the knowledge on this team trapped? I don't mean official documentation. I mean the stuff that's in someone's head that the rest of us can't access. The processes only one person knows how to run. The client history that only exists in someone's memory. The workarounds that never got written down."

Each person writes down 2-3 knowledge traps they're aware of (including their own). Collect on the flipchart/Miro and group them:

- Single-person dependencies (only Sarah knows how to run the month-end report)

- Undocumented processes (the workaround for the CRM glitch that everyone uses but nobody has written down)
- Lost knowledge (the context behind decisions made before current team members joined)
- Siloed information (Team A has data that Team B needs but doesn't know exists)

Phase 2: Risk Assessment (10 minutes)

For each knowledge trap, assess two things:

- Impact: if this knowledge disappeared tomorrow (person leaves, gets sick, changes role), how badly would it affect the team? (Low / Medium / High)
- Ease of capture: how hard would it be to document or share this knowledge? (Quick / Moderate / Complex)

The highest-priority knowledge traps are high impact and quick to capture. Start there. Don't try to document everything at once.

Phase 3: The Minimum Viable Knowledge Base (15 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"We don't need a perfect documentation system. We need a minimum viable knowledge base: the 10-15 most critical pieces of knowledge captured in a findable place. What format works for us? A shared doc? A wiki? A folder with standard templates? The format matters less than the habit."

The team agrees on:

- Where knowledge will live (one place, not scattered across five systems)
- What format (template for process documentation, keeping it simple)
- Who documents what (assign the top 5 knowledge traps to specific people with deadlines)
- When it gets reviewed (quarterly check: is it still accurate? what's missing?)

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
Someone hoards knowledge intentionally (power/security dynamic)	Do not call it out publicly. Address privately: "I've noticed that [process/knowledge] sits primarily with you. That's a compliment to your expertise, but it's also a risk for the team. Can we work together to document it so the team isn't dependent on any single person, including me?" Frame it as risk management, not criticism.
The team agrees to document but nobody follows through	Assign specific knowledge items to specific people with specific deadlines. "By Friday, Sarah documents the month-end process. By next Tuesday, James documents the CRM workaround." Accountability requires specificity.

The chosen documentation platform is too complex	Simplify ruthlessly. "If the documentation tool is harder to use than just asking someone, nobody will use it. What's the simplest format that captures the essential information?" A Google Doc with a table of contents beats a sophisticated wiki that nobody updates.
---	---

Signs This Is Working

Timeframe	What to Look For
During the session	The knowledge trap map produces genuine 'bus factor' concerns ("If X left, we'd be in trouble") The team agrees on a simple, usable documentation approach Specific assignments are made with deadlines
Within 4-6 weeks	At least 5 high-priority knowledge items have been documented Someone uses the documentation instead of asking the person directly A new team member or returning-from-leave colleague finds what they need without help
CLOVER ERA data (4-8 weeks)	Enablement scores improve Knowledge sharing signals strengthen Qualitative data references being able to find information or reduced dependency on specific people

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
E1: Shared Struggles	E1 often surfaces knowledge access as a barrier. E2 provides the systematic fix.	E1 feeds into E2
L2: Peer-to-Peer Learning	Peer learning sessions can produce documentation as a byproduct: the teacher documents what they taught.	Complementary
C1: Communication Audit	C1 maps communication channels; E2 maps knowledge locations. Both address information accessibility.	Complementary